Employee Benefits Policy

Northwind Technologies | Version 4.0, effective January 1, 2026 | Owner: Human Resources

1. Purpose and Eligibility

This policy summarizes the benefits offered to Northwind Technologies employees. Full-time employees are eligible from their first day. Part-time employees working 20 or more hours per week are eligible for health, dental and retirement benefits. Interns are not eligible unless stated.

2. Health, Dental and Vision Insurance

Northwind offers three health plans (Basic, Standard, Premium). The company pays 90% of the employee premium on all plans and 70% of dependent premiums. Coverage begins on the first day of the month following the start date. Dental and vision coverage is included at no cost to the employee.

Plan	Annual deductible	Out-of-pocket maximum
Basic	$1,500	$6,000
Standard	$750	$4,000
Premium	$250	$2,500

Employees may change plans during open enrollment each November, or within 30 days of a qualifying life event such as marriage or the birth of a child.

3. Retirement Savings

Northwind matches 100% of employee contributions up to 5% of base salary to the company retirement plan. Matching contributions vest over 3 years: 33% after year one, 66% after year two, and 100% after year three. Employees are auto-enrolled at 3% after 30 days and may change or opt out at any time.

4. Learning and Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of $1,500 for courses, certifications, books and conferences. Requests over $1,500 need VP approval. Employees who leave within 12 months of receiving reimbursement for a certification above $1,000 must repay it on a pro rata basis.

Employees may use up to 5 paid working days per year for approved training and conferences.

5. Wellness Benefits

A wellness stipend of $50 per month can be used for gym memberships, fitness classes or mental-health apps. The Employee Assistance Program (EAP) provides up to 6 free confidential

counseling sessions per issue per year for employees and their household members, available 24/7.

6. Family Support

Northwind provides a childcare subsidy of $200 per month per child under 6, up to two children. Employees can access backup care for up to 10 days per year through our care partner. Adoption and fertility assistance of up to $5,000 per lifetime is available for eligible employees.

7. Life and Disability Insurance

Basic life insurance of 2 times annual salary and short- and long-term disability insurance are provided at no cost to employees. Employees may purchase additional life coverage at group rates. Short-term disability pays 70% of salary for up to 12 weeks; long-term disability pays 60% of salary after 90 days.

8. Employee Perks

Employees receive a commuter benefit of up to $100 per month (pre-tax) for public transit or parking. Employees who refer a successful hire receive a $2,000 referral bonus, paid after the new hire completes 90 days. Work anniversaries at 5, 10 and 15 years include a recognition gift and an extra 3 days of paid leave.

Questions about benefits can be sent to benefits@northwind.example.